

The Key to Making Money as an Online Trainer

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 08, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/z4YuGXNDsK8> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Most online trainers struggle financially because they're too generic. Brandon Carter — who made his first million as an online trainer and has helped 15,000 others — explains how moving from generalist to specialist is the single key to standing out and making money.

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The Core Problem: Why Online Trainers Stay Broke 0:00

- The vast majority of online trainers struggle to make money because of **one single mistake**: being too generic
 - There are simply too many "fitness guys" and "fitness girls" for a generalist to stand out in the market
- Brandon Carter's credentials establishing why he's qualified to speak on this:
 - Made his first million dollars as an online trainer
 - Has helped over 15,000 people become successful online trainers

The Three-Question Framework: Generalist to Specialist 0:09

- To stop being a struggling generalist, you must answer three specific questions:
 - **Question 1 — Who?** Figure out exactly who you want to help (your target audience)
 - **Question 2 — What?** Identify the specific problem you want to focus on helping them solve
 - **Question 3 — How?** Define exactly how you are going to help them solve that problem
- This process is described as moving "from being a generalist to a specialist"

Case Study: Corey Armstrong 0:21

- Corey Armstrong was a struggling online personal trainer before working with Brandon Carter
- They applied the three-question framework together:

- Who: **Busy professionals**
- What: **Burn belly fat**
- How: **Intermittent fasting**
- Result: Corey went from being "just a regular fitness guy" to a trainer who "focuses on helping busy professionals burn belly fat with intermittent fasting"
 - His positioning is now a clear, specific one-sentence value proposition rather than a vague fitness brand

Why Specialization Kills Price Shopping 0:44

- When the right prospect (a busy professional who wants to burn belly fat via intermittent fasting) finds Corey, it becomes **more difficult to price shop**
 - The prospect feels they've found someone built specifically for their exact situation — generic alternatives feel like a downgrade
- Over time, Corey's testimonials compound the effect:
 - All his testimonials begin to look like the same type of person (busy professionals with the same goal)
 - When a new prospect visits his profile and sees testimonials from people "just like him who wanted to solve the exact same problem the exact same way," the decision to hire Corey becomes obvious

"When this guy sees him and he sees all these testimonials of guys who are just like him who wanted to solve the exact same problem the exact same way, of course he's going to go with Cor. That's how you stand out."

Free Tool: The Niche Validator 1:07

- Brandon offers a free tool called the **Niche Validator** to help trainers identify their best niche
 - You answer approximately **12 questions** about yourself and your profile
 - An AI then generates a few niche options that are most likely to work for you specifically
- Positioned as the actionable next step for anyone unsure of what their specialist niche should be